

Professor Assistant Program

Automated Exam Generation from a Question Bank

Team MANIAC | Python Final Project

Project Overview

Goal

Help professors automatically generate exams from a pre-built question bank

Language

Python — uses only the built-in random module

Input

question_bank.txt with Q&A pairs

Output

A saved exam file with randomly selected questions

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Program Workflow

1

Start

Professor launches the program

2

Enter Name

Validates letters-only input

3

Load Bank

Reads question_bank.txt Q&A pairs

4

Set Count

Professor picks number of questions

5

Generate

Randomly selects unique questions

6

Save Exam

Writes exam to chosen output file

Key Functions

`read_question_bank()`

Reads question_bank.txt, strips whitespace, validates even-line format, and returns a list of (question, answer) tuples. Returns None on errors.

`create_exam()`

Randomly selects unique questions using index tracking. Writes numbered Q&A pairs to the output file. Caps selection at available count.

`main()`

Controls program flow: validates professor name, loops exam creation, and displays a personalized farewell on exit.

Question Bank Format

- Plain .txt file — one question per line, answer on the next line
- Lines come in pairs: Question → Answer → Question → Answer
- Blank lines are automatically skipped during processing
- Odd number of lines signals an invalid file — returns None

`sample question_bank.txt`

Who is the father of Computer science?
`Charles Babbage`

What does CPU stand for?
`Central Processing Unit`

BIOS stands for?
`Basic Input Output System`

Contains 100 Q&A pairs on computer science fundamentals

Input Validation

Professor Name

Must contain letters only. Spaces are stripped before check. Loop repeats until valid input is given.

Question Count

If count exceeds available questions, it is automatically capped at the bank size — no crash.

File Existence

`read_question_bank()` catches `FileNotFoundError` and returns `None`, prompting a user-friendly error message.

File Format

Odd number of cleaned lines returns `None` — prevents incorrect Q&A pairing.

```
.....  
.....  
.....  
.....  
Welcome to professor assistant version 1.0.  
Please Enter Your Name: Ibrahim Musa  
Hello Professor Ibrahim Musa , I am here to help you create exams from a question_bank.txt file.  
Do you want me to help you create an exam (Yes to proceed | No to quit the program)? yes  
Yes, indeed the path you provided includes questions and answers.  
How many question-answer pairs do you want to include in your exam? 30  
Where do you want to save your exam? exam  
Congratulations Professor Ibrahim Musa .  
Your exam is created and saved in exam.
```

Sample Program Output

Challenges & Solutions

CHALLENGES

Preventing duplicate questions

Handling missing or malformed files

Capping question count safely

Keeping name input valid

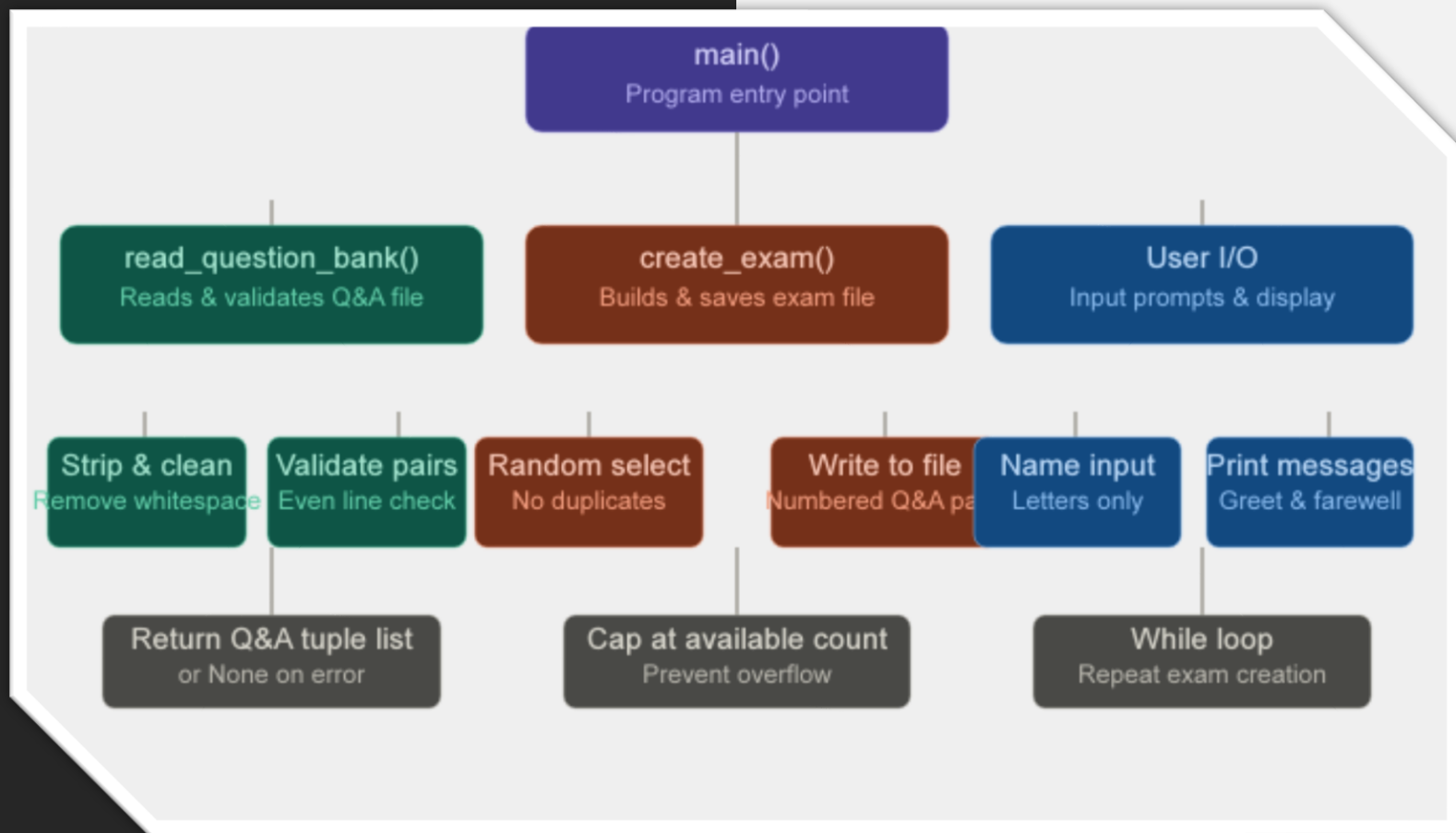
SOLUTIONS

Track used indexes in a list; loop until new index found

try/except FileNotFoundError + even-line format check

Cap total_questions to available_questions automatically

Use `.replace(' ', '').isalpha()` with a retry loop



Conclusion

- Automates exam creation — saves professors significant time
- Robust error handling for missing files and bad input
- Guarantees no duplicate questions per exam session
- Simple, clean Python design using only the random module
- Scalable: question bank can be expanded at any time